



**Minnehaha United
Methodist Church**

A Reconciling Congregation

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Rev. Jean Elliott,
Director of Children, Youth, & Their Families;
Alex Rack, *Choir Director*;
Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes, *Contemporary Band Leader*;
Nicholas and Patience Sabah,
Communion Stewards

Sign in

We are delighted you are here! We invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically.

If you point your camera phone at the QR code below, it will take you to a google form where you can enter your information.



Giving

For our offering, you can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



Children in Worship

We always welcome children in worship, and we assume that they may make noise, wriggle, and even run around. If you would like childcare during worship, we do have care for children 0-4 from 9-10 a.m. on our 2nd floor. The ushers can direct you, if you would like help finding the room. In addition, we have activity bags for children at the back of the sanctuary, and we also have rocking chairs at the back for nursing or rocking a baby. Rocking chairs are also available across from the nursery on the 2nd floor.

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December 24, 2022 4:00 p.m.

* Please rise in body or spirit

Gathering Music

Hannah Scholen, *featured vocals*

I Wonder as I Wander, The Holly and the Ivy, Bring a Torch, Jeanette Isabella

A Christmas Gathering

(Medley: *Lo, How A Rose E'er Blooming,*

Welcome

Lighting of the Advent Wreath

(adapted from a prayer by Rev. Sarah (Are) Speed, A Sanctified Art LLC, sanctifiedart.org)

Sarah, Jason, Calvin, and Elias Emrick

Leader: In God's house, there is hope --

People: **For God loves us too much to leave us just as we were.**

(Light the candle of hope)

Leader: In God's house, there is peace --

People: **For all that separates us from God falls away.**

(Light the candle of peace)

Leader: In God's house, there is joy --

People: **Because God created music, and coffee, and sippy cups, and dance floors, and laughter that is contagious, and endless rounds of peek-a-boo with babies; and if those things have God's fingerprints, then God's house surely exudes joy.**

(Light the candle of joy)

Leader: In God's house, there is love --

People: **Because God is love, from start to finish, and that love exists for us all.**

(Light the candle of love)

Leader: Tonight we tell the story that we tell every year – the story of Christ's birth, the story of love made flesh. It's a story that weaves through every generation. It's a story that picks up the bits and pieces of our narrative and braids us together.

People: **So tonight we light the Christ candle, because from generation to generation, our story belongs to God. Thanks be to God for a love like that.**

(Light the Christ candle)

*Hymn

O Come, All Ye Faithful

The United Methodist Hymnal #234 vv. 1-4

John F. Wade (ca. 1743)

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In verse 2 feel free to sing "Maker" instead of "Father"

Christmas Prayer

(adapted from a prayer by Rev. Sarah (Are) Speed, A Sanctified Art LLC, sanctifiedart.org)

Author of our lives, joy and hope are in the air! So thick, we could almost bottle it up.

But we don't want to bottle up this feeling; we want to share it. We want to share the joy of this night

**with the children of this city,
with single parents,
with lonely young adults,
with our unhoused neighbors,
with those who are grieving,
with people who couldn't quite make it home for Christmas.**

We want to share this hope with people who had imagined that this year would be different, that this year they would have what they were looking for. We want to share this night with families who couldn't afford to put much under the tree, as well as with those who are new to this country – fleeing a life that was unsafe or unwelcoming.

We don't want to bottle up the magic of this night; we want to share it. We want to pour your good news all over this community. We want to sing like Mary sang, until all who are looking for you have found their way home.

So help us live like the shepherds – who weren't afraid to go and tell the good news.

Help us take the words of the angels to heart – to not be afraid.

Help us to be as trusting as Joseph – who chose to believe the impossible.

But more than anything, give us the courage and conviction to tell this story. Amen.

Special Music

Jason Vosu, vocals

Nothing But a Child

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Reading

Isaiah 9:2, 6-7

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #228

He Is Born

French carol, harm. Carlton R. Young (1988)

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Children's Message

Jean Elliott

Reading

Luke 2:1-7

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #228

Away in a Manger

James R. Murray (1887)

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Reading

Luke 2:8-20

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #238

Angels We Have Heard on High

French carol, Harm. © 1964 Abingdon Press

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Sermon

“We Tell This Story”

Reading

Psalm 98

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #246

Joy to the World

Isaac Watts (1719) G. F. Handel (1741)

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Offering of Gifts and Tithes

Special Music

Kit Campbell, Julia Cook, Judi Bartlett, Julie Darlington, *vocals*

Beautiful Star Of Bethlehem

©1938 A.L. Phipps; Fort Knox Music, Trio Music (BMI)

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Prayer of Dedication

May these gifts of time, talent, and treasure proclaim your saving action in Jesus Christ. Through our offerings, empower this church to share the good news we have seen and heard. Equip us to sing with angels and run with shepherds. Fill us with your peace, that we may live more fully as peacemakers. Expand the horizons of our understanding and expectation, that we may move with confidence into these wider arenas where you call us to serve. *Amen.*

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #239 (with flashlights)

Silent Night

Joseph Mohr, Franz Gruber (1818)

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Benediction

Traveling Music

Judi Bartlett, *vocals*

Getting Ready For Christmas Day

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POINSETTIAS

THIS CHRISTMAS EVE ARE GIVEN BY:

Judy Durfey in gratitude for prayers and support from the MUMC congregation.

Diane & Bob Enge in loving memory of our fathers.

Diane & Bob Enge in honor of our mothers.

Sarah Hicks in memory of loved ones.

Craig & Char Johnson in memory of loved ones.

Peter & Sue Johnson in celebration of family.

Patricia Roth in memory of Joan Ellison.

James Shetler in honor of Eleanore's kids in Ukraine.



WELCOME TO ALL VISITING THIS CHRISTMAS EVE!

We're so glad you're here. If you're seeking a church that feels like "home," we hope you'll consider Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We're a thriving multi-generational, multi-cultural congregation. Our Christian faith drives us to take action in our neighborhood through local missions, activism, and sharing the unconditional love of God with our neighbors. We make good things happen here.



We think you'll find ours a community that has a lot to offer:

- A place where **everyone is welcome**
- Faith development in a **positive, non-judgmental** way
- **Meaningful worship** with varied music and two different Sunday morning worship services (9 and 11), both of which are livestreamed.
- **Dynamic children & youth programs** with support for parents
- Lots of opportunities for **service to others**
- The opportunity for close, **life-long friendships**

To find out more, visit our website (www.minnehaha.org) or contact our pastor, Becky Sechrist (becky@minnehaha.org). Thank you for your visit. We hope you'll come back soon.

WINTER SERIES

This January and February we will be exploring a variety of Liberation theologies, looking at the Bible and the world through a particular lens, such as the lens of poverty, the lens of women, the lens of people of color, the lens of the environment. In addition, our Monday evening and Tuesday morning studies will focus on the book *Transforming: The Bible and the Lives of Transgender Christians* by local author Austen Hartke. There will be a special service on January 15 with one worship service at 10:00 featuring a reading of the Letter from a Birmingham Jail interspersed with gospels and spirituals. We hope you'll join us for worship or study!

The Return of Playgroup!

Playgroup is returning on Thursdays starting January 5 from 9:30-11:30 am in Rooms 202 & 204.

All children 5 and under and their caretakers are invited to stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together! (Feel free to bring snacks if your child(ren) wants them, but no peanuts.)

For more information, contact Katie Klug at katieklug5112@gmail.com

